

KSUM NEWSLETTER

JULY
2024



Kerala has around 5400 + startups working in various sectors spread across its 14 districts. Our startups work in wide range of sectors including Artificial Intelligence, Hardware, Healthcare, Fin tech, Bio Technology etc.

BEYOND TOMORROW 2024

SHAPING KERALA'S CULTURAL CREATIVE ECONOMY

'Beyond Tomorrow 2024,' organized by Kerala Startup Mission (KSUM) in partnership with the Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce & Industry (FICCI), was held on July 20, 2024, at Le Méridien, Kochi. Supported by The Art Outreach Society (TAOS), UNESCO, TeamWork Arts, SAIK (Society of AVGC Institutions in Kerala), Avid Learning, Art Links Learning, and the British Council, the event explored the future of Kerala's cultural and creative sectors, examining their potential to foster economic and social growth. As a precursor to the inaugural session in New Delhi in August 2024, Beyond Tomorrow featured presentations and panel discussions led by industry experts.

The conclave highlighted the creative sector's vital role in driving innovation, advancing technology, and promoting sustainability. Key focus areas included the impact of digital integration, artificial



intelligence, and emerging technologies on the arts; strategies for incorporating arts and culture into education to cultivate a skilled talent pool; and the potential of cultural heritage to boost tourism and stimulate economic growth. Policy discussions further illuminated the significant influence of the creative sector economy in Kerala. The event concluded with an industry roundtable on July 21, 2024, entitled "Dialogue and Discussions for Future Work" at Le Méridien, Kochi.

The conference successfully showcased the transformative power of the creative sector in shaping Kerala's future, setting the stage for further discussions in New Delhi.



GEN AI CONCLAVE

India's inaugural International GenAI Conclave made waves as it kicked off in Kochi. The event, a testament to Kerala's growing prominence in the AI sphere, witnessed the active participation of key industry players.

Honourable Minister P Rajeev showcased his support by visiting an exhibition of AI startups curated by the Kerala Startup Mission. The event also featured a panel discussion on fostering a supportive GenAI ecosystem in Kerala, with Kerala Startup Mission CEO Shri Anoop Ambika as a key panelist.



KSUM AND HP INDIA PARTNER TO EMPOWER KERALA STARTUPS

Kerala Startup Mission has signed a landmark Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with, HP India Sales Private Limited. The collaboration will offer startups exclusive access to expert guidance on the latest trends and innovations in digital packaging, marking a significant advancement in our startup ecosystem.

Glimpses from "Going Global with Digital Packaging" session, hosted by KSUM and HP. Startups gained invaluable insights from Mr. A Appadurai on leveraging cutting-edge digital packaging solutions to enhance their marketing and sales strategies.

The hands-on experience with packaging materials sparked renewed interest in this vital business aspect.



MOU WITH HERO MOTO CORP

Hero MotoCorp Limited and Kerala Startup Mission have signed an MoU to foster the startup ecosystem in Kerala! This partnership, signed by Mr. Swadesh Kumar Srivastava, Chief Business Officer, Emerging Mobility of Hero MotoCorp Limited, and Mr. Anoop Ambika, CEO of KSUM, in the presence of Dr. Rathan U Kelkar, IAS, Secretary (E & ITD), marks a significant step



towards promoting innovation and entrepreneurship in the state. KSUM will provide startup support, workshops, sessions, awareness campaigns, and state support to selected startups. The partnership aims to align startups with HMCL's focus areas, provide resources and support, and organize awareness campaigns.



FOUNDERS MEET- CHENNAI

The 21st edition of Founders Meet, organized by Startup Founders of Kerala, was held on July 19, 2024, at Crescent Innovation & Incubation Council, Chennai. The program aimed to connect founders, share experiences, and provide invaluable insights for the startup journey. The event featured distinguished speakers, including Parvez Alem M, Executive Director of CIIC & AIC-CIIC and President of

PMICC; Moin SPM, Co-founder & COO of AgniKul Cosmos; and Anoop Ambika, CEO of Kerala Startup Mission.

Key takeaways included strategies for overcoming challenges at various stages of growth, building a strong founders' network, and practical advice from experienced entrepreneurs. The event facilitated

meaningful connections and knowledge exchange, preparing attendees for the hurdles they may face as startup founders. The Founders Meet successfully empowered participants with the tools and insights needed to navigate the complexities of startup growth.



MOU WITH CIIC TO EXTEND LEAP (LAUNCH EMPOWER ACCELERATE PROSPER) CENTERS TO CHENNAI AND BENGALURU

Kerala Startup Mission has signed an MOU with CIIC to extend LEAP (Launch Empower Accelerate Prosper) Centers to Chennai and Bengaluru through CIIC facilities. This collaboration aims to boost innovation and entrepreneurship in these vibrant cities. Stay tuned for more updates.



STARTUP 360 DRIVE

The Startup 360 Drive program, held from June 28th to July 31st, offered comprehensive support to startup founders across Kerala. The venues included Palakkad, Kozhikode, Malappuram, Wayanad and Kannur. The goal was to equip entrepreneurs with knowledge in Legal & IP, Technology, Business



Development, HR, and Finance Management.

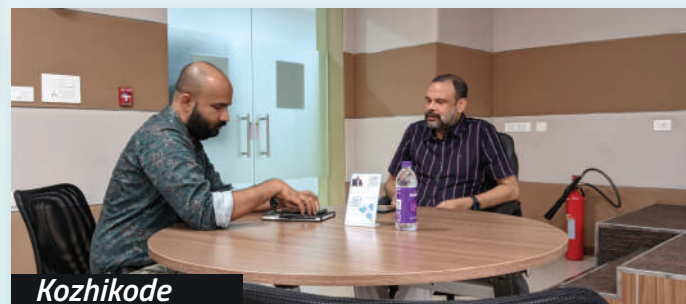
Participants received one-on-one consultations from industry experts, providing personalized guidance and actionable insights. The program



successfully enhanced founders' abilities to launch and scale their startups, addressing critical challenges in the startup ecosystem



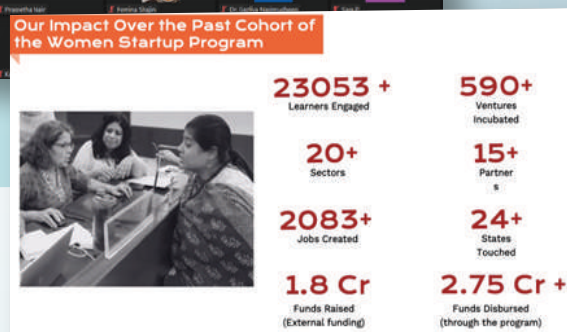
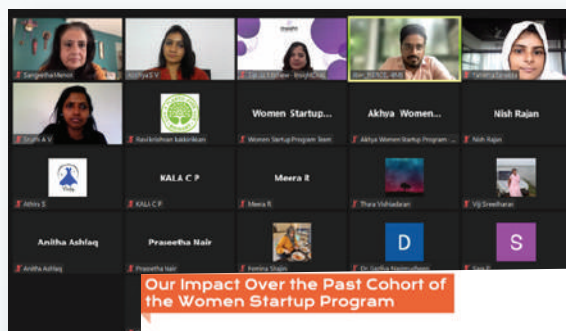
Key takeaways included strategies for legal compliance, technology use, business growth, team management, and financial planning. The program had a significant impact, providing essential tools and knowledge for successful entrepreneurship.



WESTART PRE-INCUBATION PROGRAM FOR WOMEN: COHORT 2 KICK-OFF !

The WeStart Pre-Incubation Program for Women, Cohort 2, kicked off to a resounding start on July 23, 2024. The online event brought together aspiring women entrepreneurs and industry leaders for an inspiring and informative session.

The cohort kicked off with esteemed speakers like Deepa Sarojammal, CEO of Reflections Info Systems, Sonia Mohandas, Director at Waferchips, and Jayashree S, Founder of ProfileUP, sharing their invaluable insights and experiences.



LEADER CONNECT

The Leader Connect session was held on July 18th, 2024, at 4:30 PM at Kerala Startup Mission, Kalamassery, Kochi. The event featured Bibu Punnooran, Director of Medivision Group of Diagnostic Centres and President of Kerala Management Association, in conversation with Vivek Krishna Govind, Vice President of TiE Kerala and Senior Partner at Varma & Varma CAs.

The session aimed to provide attendees with the chance to learn from and interact with market leaders, gaining insights into their successful entrepreneurial journeys. Bibu Punnooran shared his experiences with Medivision Group, emphasizing the importance of high-quality diagnostic services and innovative technology.

Key takeaways included strategies for achieving success in the healthcare industry, maintaining service quality, and leveraging technology for business growth. The session offered practical advice and inspiration to aspiring entrepreneurs.



MY STORY SESSION

The "My Story Session" was held on 24th July 2024 at Kerala Startup Mission, Kalamassery, Kochi. The objective was to inspire and educate participants about the impact of AI in the automobile industry. Dr. Roshy John, founder and CEO of RoshAI, a pioneer in India's driverless car revolution, along

with his co-founder, Rajaram Moorthy, shared their journey of scaling an ultra-deep tech startup from a Tier 2 city to global success.

Key takeaways included the challenges of developing AI-driven solutions, strategies for scaling tech startups, and the importance of perseverance. The session, starting at 4:30 PM, left a lasting impact, motivating attendees to embrace innovation and leverage technology for transformative change. Dr. John's story highlighted the potential of AI in revolutionizing industries and the significance of nurturing tech startups in emerging cities.



IN50 HOURS - KOCHI

The In 50 hours event, held from July 5 to July 7, 2024, at ISC Kochi, successfully brought together 63 participants from diverse backgrounds to foster collaboration and innovation. With 305 initial registrations, the event curated a group of ideators, developers, and designers who created functional prototypes within 50 hours.



The event aimed to bridge the gap between practitioners with innovative ideas and technical experts. Participants formed 15 teams to develop prototypes, showcasing their collaborative efforts and technical skills. The event received high praise for its mentorship, collaboration, and rapid prototyping.

Key takeaways included strategies for effective collaboration, the importance of mentorship, and the benefits of rapid prototyping. The successful realization of innovative ideas highlighted the event's potential for driving future technological advancements. The positive feedback has encouraged organizers to plan future iterations of In50hrs, building on this success.



WIIT WORKSHOP FOR WOMEN

On July 27th, 2024, WIIT 10000 Women launched its pilot batch, "Return to Work Assistance" at Kerala Startup Mission, Kalamassery, Kochi. The Program is organized by WIIT and the Kerala Development & Innovation Strategic Council (K-DISC) in partnership with Kerala Knowledge Economy Mission (KKEM). This initiative supports women re-entering the workforce after a career break. The program began with a Confidence Building and Empowerment Session by Ms. Rakhee Vijay, followed by a Mindset Development & Wellbeing Session by Dr. Anu Suraj.



SUPER FAB SUNDAY

Kerala Startup mission through Fab Lab Trivandrum ignited the spark of creativity on July 28th with the SuperFab Sunday workshop on 2D Designing and Laser Cutting Machining.

The day unfolded with an immersive hands-on experience, where participants were guided through the intricacies of digital design. From conceptualization to execution, the workshop fostered a vibrant learning environment. The highlight was undoubtedly the opportunity to transform digital designs into tangible creations using the state-of-the-art laser cutting machine.



VENTURE CAPITAL 101 BOOTCAMP

VC 101 Bootcamp provided D2C startups with essential knowledge on fundraising. Industry experts, Siddhant Gupta and Dr. Nayana Sivaraj, shared invaluable insights into securing investments and scaling businesses. Attendees gained practical advice on crafting compelling pitches, identifying potential investors, and navigating the complex world of venture capital.



IEDC PROJECT OF THE MONTH

A FUSION OF ART, TECHNOLOGY, AND ENTREPRENEURSHIP

From the corridors of St. Thomas College in Ranny, Pathanamthitta, a young mind is crafting a future where art and technology are inseparable. Kevin Anjo, a name synonymous with innovation, is the driving force behind VArts World Pvt. Ltd. (VAW), a company that's not just building products, but rewriting the rules of the game.

VAW is a melting pot of creativity and tech prowess. One moment, they're developing ARM robots to lend a hand to small businesses, and the next, they're reimagining how we cherish memories with innovative digital albums. Their project, Saira, is a testament to their problem-solving acumen, offering swift solutions to daily business needs.

But Anjo's ambitions stretch beyond the commercial. Alongside VAW, he also founded Theo, a non-profit organization dedicated to making a positive difference through education. E-SchoolBooks is a bold step towards democratizing education, making learning engaging and accessible for all. Then there's the ambitious AI with Sanskrit project, a bridge between the ancient and the modern, showcasing a deep-rooted respect for heritage combined with a forward-looking tech vision.



Kevin Anjo is more than just an entrepreneur; he's a visionary. He's not just building a company, but a legacy. As he continues to push boundaries, his journey is a beacon of hope for a generation of young Indians who dream big and dare to disrupt. Kerala's startup ecosystem is lucky to have him.

On a proud note, it's a pleasure to announce that V-Arts has officially been recognized as a Private Limited Company by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs! This marks a historic milestone - the first student-run private limited company at St. Thomas College in Ranny.



GOVERNMENT AS A MARKETPLACE

SI No	Name of the Department	Requirement	Startup	Amount Approved (in Lakhs)
01	Department of Civil Supplies & Consumer Affairs	Ration Card Rights Application	Kawika	3.5
02	Kerala Land Development Corporation Ltd	Project Monitoring System	Travansoft	8.75
03	The Travancore Cochin Chemicals Ltd	Development of a Mobile Application for Employee and Payroll management	Travidux Technologies	6
04	Smart City Trivandrum Limited	Solar Scada API Integration	Doomsquare Micro Systems Pvt Ltd	14.5
05	Clappana Grama Panchayat	Virtual Therapy Unit	Embright Infotech Pvt Ltd	8.13
06	Kerala Knowledge Economy Mission	Development of Website	Kawika	4.3
07	Kerala State Science and Technology Museum & Priyadarshini Planetarium	Installation of Computer Gallery Phase 2	Interactive Museum Consultants Pvt Ltd	28.56

JUNE

No of EOIs	6
Project Under Evaluation	12
Projects Approved	7
Value of work orders(in Lakhs)	73.74
Active EOIs	2

RINK

Kerala Startup Mission (KSUM) is delighted to announce strategic partnerships with the Indian Institute of Science Education and Research (IISER), Thiruvananthapuram and the National Institute of Electronics & Information Technology (NIELIT), Calicut to bolster the state's startup ecosystem.

These collaborations aim to provide KSUM's UID startups with access to world-class facilities and expertise at reduced rates.

The Central Instrumentation Facility (CIF) at IISER offers state-of-the-art resources for the advanced characterisation of molecular compounds and materials, providing startups with the tools to drive groundbreaking innovations.

The collaboration with NIELIT Calicut, KSUM aims to promote scientific research, innovation, and entrepreneurship in the IT and electronics sector. These partnerships underscore KSUM's commitment to fostering a thriving startup ecosystem in Kerala by providing startups with the necessary resources and support to succeed.



MENTORSHIP STATS

06

STARTUPS

13

MENTORS

15

INTERACTIONS

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Have a thought, comment or suggestion to share with us?

We'd love to hear from you.
Write to us at



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